



Driverless hover-taxi

Test flights of Volocopter's electric air taxis will take place in Singapore next year. <https://digit.in/nov-18-39-1>



Motorola supports Right to Repair

Motorola has partnered with iFixit to become the first smartphone company to sell DIY repair kits. <https://digit.in/nov-18-39-2>

Mi TV 4A Pro 49-inch

Fantastic 1080p performance, bleak HDR



The Xiaomi Mi LED TV 4A Pro TV runs Android TV 8.1 out of the box, along with the company's own PatchWall OS. This is the first time Xiaomi has launched a 49-inch TV in India and it's packed with several features. Should the competition be worried?

Design

Although it isn't the slimmest television in the market, it does have relatively slim bezels around the display which give the TV a nice look. The design of the Xiaomi Mi LED TV 4A Pro is simple, it serves its purpose and we like it.

Connectivity

3 HDMI ports are a good number, but the lack of audio outputs like RCA or 3.5mm is disappointing. The placement of the HDMI ports is quite convenient – all of them are on the side which means that they are easy to reach even when the TV is wall mounted. You will still need an HDMI extender if you want to connect an Amazon Fire TV Stick.

Display and picture quality

The 4A Pro has a Full HD panel and boasts support for HDR. Xiaomi says that the TV will be available in VA and IPS panel options but they didn't disclose the panel manufacturer. Our review unit had an IPS panel.

When the HDMI 2.0 option was switched off, the performance of the TV was fantastic. We ran our standard set of content from the Xbox One X which was Netflix and Amazon Prime videos. You will thoroughly enjoy watching any kind of 1080p content on this TV.

If you truly want to enjoy the picture potential of the TV, we suggest

Price
₹29,999



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switching HDR off. If 4K is important to you, then we suggest you go for the Mi LED TV 4 Pro 55-inch which has a 10-bit 4K HDR panel.

Gaming performance

The TV has a game mode which helps with input lag and picture settings.

PS4 Pro and Xbox One X owners can exploit the high frame rate modes in games as the TV supports 60 FPS.

We played Forza Horizon 3, Rise of the Tomb Raider and some Gears 4 on the TV and it looked fantastic as long as HDMI 2.0 was switched off.

PatchWall OS

The new version of PatchWall runs on Android TV 8.1. This is the full-blown version of Android found mostly on Sony TVs. Android 8 itself feels smoother than previous versions of Android and the UI addresses a lot of issues we've had with the Android TV OS in the past. Xiaomi is giving users the best of both worlds – stock Android 8.1 and PatchWall based on Android 8.1.

Benchmarks

We used the Spider Elite 4 to test the TV and the results are a mixed bag.

The brightness of the TV is decent, colour uniformity is good and so is the luminance uniformity. However, the colour accuracy as per the Spider isn't great. This is, of course, keeping in mind ideal situations. In real-world usage, the TV does a fine job of showcasing content consumed regularly at home.

TV speaker quality

The TV has two down-firing 10W speakers. We aren't generally a fan of the speakers on a TV but the ones on the Xiaomi Mi LED TV 4A Pro are decent and get the job

done for everyday viewing. However, if you want to enjoy a movie or games with all the bangs and swishes, you will need to invest in a soundbar or a speaker set.

Remote control

The remote control is minimalistic, functional and works well. It builds upon a remote that we liked. Although a dedicated mute button and menu button are missed. You can bring up the menu by clicking the centre button, but intuitively, that is more of a select button than a menu button.

Verdict

Considering the features on offer, the 4A Pro is a good buy for those looking for a 50-inch smart TV. However, if you still want to go 4K, you may need to increase your budget. For ₹30,000 you are getting a pretty good FHD smart TV proposition with the 4A Pro.

–Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 49-inch | PANEL TYPE: IPS | PANEL RESOLUTION: 1920x1080p Full HD | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: No | WEIGHT (WITH STAND): 10.9kgs | HDMI PORTS: 3 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: Yes, 4.2 | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 8GB

CONTACT

XIAOMI | WEBSITE: mi.com/in | PHONE: 1800 103 6286 | EMAIL: service.in@xiaomi.com